

Course Hub – Search & Filter User Manual

Purpose

The Course Hub helps students quickly find courses in the IBM SkillsBuild catalogue without scrolling through a long list. Users can search by course code or title, filter by category, limit results by maximum duration, and mark courses as done to earn points.

1) Opening the Course Hub

1. Open the web application.
2. Navigate to the /courses page (Course Hub).
3. The page will show:
 - A Search & Filter bar
 - A results table (Code, Title, Category, Duration, Languages, Done)
 - A Points counter in the top-right

2) Searching by Course Code or Title

What it does

- The search box checks BOTH the course code and the course title.
- Search is case-insensitive (AI-037 and ai-037 behave the same).
- Partial matches work (you do not need to type the full title).

How to use it

1. Click the “Search code or title” input box.
2. Type either:
 - A full course code (example: AI-037), OR
 - Keywords from the title (example: language models)
3. Click “Search”.
4. The results table will update to show only matching courses.

Example

- Input: AI-037
- Output: The course with code AI-037 (if it exists in the catalogue).

3) Filtering by Category

What it does

- The category dropdown shows only courses belonging to the selected category.

How to use it

1. Open the “Any category” dropdown.
2. Select a category (example: Artificial Intelligence).
3. Click “Search”.
4. The results table will update to show only courses in that category.

4) Limiting Results by Maximum Duration

What it does

- The Max duration filter shows only courses with duration less than or equal to the number entered.

How to use it

1. Click the “Max duration (mins)” input box.
2. Enter a number (example: 60).
3. Click “Search”.
4. The results table will update to show only courses that take 60 minutes or less.

Example

- Max duration: 60
- Output: All courses with duration $\leq$ 60 minutes.

5) Using Multiple Filters Together

You can combine up to three filters at once:

- Search text + Category + Max duration

How to use it

1. Enter a search term (optional).
2. Select a category (optional).

3. Enter a maximum duration (optional).
4. Click “Search”.
5. Only courses that match ALL active filters will be shown.

Example

- Search: “AI”
- Category: Artificial Intelligence
- Max duration: 90
- Output: AI-category courses matching “AI” in code/title with duration $\leq$ 90 minutes.

6) Resetting Filters

What it does

- Reset clears all filters and returns the page to showing the full catalogue list.

How to use it

1. Click “Reset”.
2. Search text clears, category returns to “Any”, max duration clears.
3. Full results are shown again.

7) Understanding the Results Table

Each row represents one course:

- Code: Course/module code (e.g., AI-001)
- Title: Course name
- Category: Topic area (e.g., Artificial Intelligence)
- Duration (mins): Estimated time in minutes
- Languages: Languages the course is available in
- Done: Checkbox used to mark completion in the web app

Sorting

- Results are displayed in a consistent order (currently sorted by course code alphabetically) so the list is predictable and easy to scan.

8) Marking a Course as Done (Points System)

What it does

- Ticking the Done checkbox marks a course as completed in the web app and contributes to the Points counter.

How to use it

1. Find the course you completed (use search/filter if needed).
2. Tick the checkbox in the “Done” column.
3. Confirm the Points value (top-right) updates accordingly.

Note

- “Done” indicates completion within this project web app’s tracking system. It does not automatically confirm completion on the official IBM SkillsBuild website.

Planned Future Improvements (Optional)

- Click-to-sort table headers (Code, Title, Category, Duration) to allow interactive sorting.
- Direct links from courses to the IBM SkillsBuild website (requires login handling).